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Digital Marketing Course Selling Plan

Executive Summary

Purpose. This report explains how to position, price, promote and sell our digital marketing course in a market where at least eight Kerala-area institutes already compete for the same students. It combines the competitor analysis with proven course-marketing practices from two industry guides (Arlo and Zoho TrainerCentral).

What the competitor analysis showed

- Eight institutes were reviewed: CDA Academy, Zoople Technologies, Haris & Co Academy (HACA), DigitalX Marketers Academy, Unlearn Academy, Dotin Digital Academy, Sizcom and Techoriz.
- Course durations vary from 3 months (Unlearn) to 4 months (CDA, Zoople), 6 months plus a 1-month internship (HACA) and 240 hours (DigitalX). Dotin offers 4 and 6 month options.
- Almost all competitors target the same groups: students, graduates, job seekers and career changers. Several also target freelancers and business owners.
- Exact upcoming batch dates are mostly unconfirmed. Only Dotin's October 2026 dates were previously listed (19 Oct Kozhikode, 21 Oct Thiruvananthapuram, 26 Oct Kochi and Thrissur), and these must be verified before use.
- Competitors look alike. A generic "learn digital marketing" message will not stand out.

Key conclusions

1. **Do not sell a syllabus. Sell a result.** Students buy a job, clients or a freelance income, not 40 hours of video.
2. **Niche down.** Choose a specific outcome or audience (for example, job-ready graduates, freelancers, or local business owners) rather than competing as a general course.
3. **Prove it.** Student projects, testimonials, verified placement outcomes and our own campaign results are the strongest selling tools.
4. **Use a funnel, not a single ad.** Free content, then a free workshop or lead magnet, then counselling, then admission.
5. **Start with graduates aged 21 to 25.** They are Priority 1 from the competitor analysis. Students aged 17 to 20 build awareness, and professionals and business owners follow.
6. **Start promotion 4 to 6 weeks before every batch,** and track enquiries, counselling bookings, admissions and cost per admission from day one.

Recommended first move. Verify competitor batch dates and fees, fix our unique selling point, run a free live workshop for graduates, and measure results over the first 90 days.

What to Check Before We Sell

These are the things to confirm first. Selling before these are clear wastes advertising money

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Area	What to Check	Why It Matters
Market and Niche	Identify the target audience and outcomes, such as job seekers, freelancers, and business owners.	Generic courses face competition from free and low-cost platforms like HubSpot Academy and Udemy.
Learner Persona	Age, qualification, occupation, goals, pain points, preferred language, and platform.	Helps align course positioning and content with learner needs through surveys, interviews, and online forums.
Competitors	Verify batch dates, fees, duration, internships, placement claims, social media activity, and student reviews.	Identifies market gaps and student pain points that our course can address.
Our USP	Define differences in teaching style, practical projects, internships, delivery mode, and trainer experience.	A clear and consistent USP strengthens marketing and brand positioning.
Course Quality	Review curriculum, learning sequence, content quality, hands-on projects, and delivery style.	High-quality learning encourages recommendations and supports business growth.
Pricing	Compare competitor fees, course costs, revenue targets, instalments, and payment options.	Ensures competitive pricing without compromising quality or profitability.
Proof Assets	Collect student projects, testimonials, trainer profiles, and campaign results.	Builds credibility and trust among potential learners.
Website and Sales Page	Check mobile responsiveness, loading speed, syllabus, fees, batch dates, enquiry options, and registration.	A clear, user-friendly website helps convert visitors into leads and admissions.

How to Sell the Course

Position around a result

Sell the transformation. Examples of outcome-based positioning:

- **For graduates:** "Job-ready in digital marketing with a real portfolio."
- **For career switchers:** "Move into digital marketing alongside your current job with weekend or online batches."
- **For freelancers and business owners:** "Get your first clients, or get enquiries for your own business, using SEO, Google Ads and social media."

Once the USP is fixed, repeat it on the website, course listing, social media, brochures and emails.

Build a sales funnel

Stage	Goal	Activities
Awareness (top)	Be seen by the right people	Short videos, career guidance, SEO and social media tips, YouTube, LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook
Interest and nurture (middle)	Turn interest into trust	Free mini-course or live workshop, free template pack, email or WhatsApp follow-up over 5 to 7 days, answering objections such as "I have no tech experience"
Decision (bottom)	Convert to admission	Counselling call, syllabus, fee and batch details, testimonials, limited-time offer, easy registration
Retention	Reviews and referrals	Feedback survey, reviews, referral rewards, advanced courses

Lead with a low-risk hook

People rarely buy an expensive course from a stranger on first contact. Use:

- A **free live workshop** (about 45 minutes) on a practical topic, with the course pitched at the end.
- A **free lead magnet** such as ad copy templates or a career roadmap PDF, to collect contact details.
- **Freemium access** to a few sample lessons, so learners can experience the teaching first.

Sell proof, not the syllabus

- Show student projects, before-and-after outcomes and testimonials.
- Share our own campaign results with sensitive data hidden.
- Build implementation work into the course, such as a live landing page, a small test ad or a real business profile audit, so students finish with a portfolio.
- Collect reviews after each batch on Google, Facebook and our website. Most buyers read reviews before purchasing.

Structure the offer and price

- **Tiered options:** self-study (videos and templates), group or community (live Q&A), and mentorship or placement support at a higher price.
- **Flexible formats:** weekend, online or blended batches for working professionals.
- **Seasonal and early-bird offers** for limited periods, and a **referral reward** for existing students.
- **Easy payment:** several payment methods and instalment options, with a simple sales page and registration process.
- **Cross-sell and upsell:** advanced modules, workshops or bundles for existing students.

Scope: How to Reach Customers

Channels

Channel	Type	How to use it	Best audience
Instagram and YouTube	Organic	Short videos, tutorials, teardowns of real ads, student stories	17 to 25
LinkedIn	Organic	Keyword-optimised profile, regular expert posts, career content	21 to 35, professionals
Facebook	Organic and paid	Community, course announcements, reviews	21 to 45
Google search and My Business	Organic and paid	SEO blog posts, Google Business listing, Search Ads for people looking for courses	Job seekers, ready-to-buy leads
Meta ads (Instagram and Facebook)	Paid	Targeted ads and retargeting website visitors with testimonials and offers	All groups
Email and WhatsApp or SMS	Owned	Nurture sequences, batch reminders, offers	Existing leads
Course marketplaces and directories	Listing	List the course where people already search, accepting a commission or fee	Active searchers
Free workshops, college seminars, meet-ups	Offline and online	Guest talks, campus sessions, free sessions with a first-booking discount	Students and graduates
Referrals and affiliates	Performance-based	Reward students and influencers for admissions through unique links	Word-of-mouth reach
Influencers,podcasts, guest blogs	Collaboration	Partner with relevant creators, guest posts with a link back to our site	Wider audience, backlinks

Reach by audience

Priority	Audience	Main message	Main channels
1	Graduates and job seekers, 21 to 25	Job-ready skills, portfolio, internship	Instagram, YouTube, Google search, WhatsApp, free workshops
2	Students, 17 to 20	Explore a digital career, learn practical skills early	Instagram Reels, YouTube, college sessions

3	Working professionals and career changers, 26 to 35	Flexible weekend or online learning, career transition	LinkedIn, Google search, emai
4	Entrepreneurs and business owners, 28 to 45	Get enquiries and customers for your own business	Facebook, Google Ads, LinkedIn, case studies

The source guides also recommend deciding whether to sell **regionally** (local language, local payment methods) or **globally** (price adjusted to local purchasing power, international payment gateways). For our Kerala-area focus, regional targeting in Malayalam and English with local payment methods is the practical starting point.

Timing

Follow the campaign timeline from the competitor report, measured from our confirmed batch date:

Timing	Activity
4 to 6 weeks before	Awareness posts, career guidance, free workshop announcement
2 to 3 weeks before	Syllabus, projects, testimonials, counselling bookings
1 week before	Confirmed batch date, schedule, fee, registration link
Final days	Follow-ups and admission reminders, if seats remain
After the batch starts	Classroom and project content to build credibility for the next batch

Peak enrolment periods to test: March to May, May to July, August to October, and November to January.

90-Day Action Plan

Period	Actions
Days 1 to 15	Verify competitor dates, fees and claims. Fix USP, persona and pricing. Set up tracking, the lead sheet or CRM and the sales page
Days 16 to 45	Start organic content. Launch the lead magnet. Run the first free workshop for graduates. Begin small test ads
Days 46 to 75	Counselling calls, testimonials, retargeting ads, email and WhatsApp nurturing. Launch the early-bird offer
Days 76 to 90	Review results, collect first reviews, start the referral programme, plan the next batch

What to Measure

- Leads by channel and by age group
- Workshop registrations and attendance
- Counselling bookings
- Admissions and conversion rate from lead to admission
- Cost per lead and cost per admission
- Review count and rating
- Referral admissions

Review weekly. Change targeting or keywords in larger steps about once a month, so there is enough data to judge the result.

Notes and Cautions

- Statistics in the source guides (for example, that 95% of customers read reviews before buying, or podcast and TikTok engagement figures) come from third-party blogs published by software vendors. Treat them as indicators and verify before quoting them publicly.
- The competitor findings on batch dates, fees and demographics are unconfirmed in many cases and need direct verification.
- Age-group priorities are starting hypotheses. Validate them with real enquiry and admission data.